

Actions on Google

Creating apps for the Google Assistant

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GOOGLE HOME

Google Home is the latest in a long line of market disrupting products that have come from the path breaking technology company. It is a collection of smart speakers that enable users to use voice commands in order to interact with services through Google's intelligent personal assistant called Google Assistant. Google Assistant hosts a large number of services, both within and outside Google that are integrated and synchronized, allowing users to perform a variety of tasks from listening to music, to playing videos or viewing photos on your smart

TV, or even receiving news updates entirely by voice. These devices also have support for home automation, letting users control smart home appliances such as air conditioners and security alarms with their voice. You can even set up multiple such devices across a home to allow synchronized playback of music and complete automation. In 2017, Google even added a special feature that allows the Google Assistant to detect and distinguish between up to six voices.

GOOGLE ASSISTANT & ACTIONS ON GOOGLE

Google Assistant is a virtual personal assistant (VPA) developed by Google that is at the heart of its Google Home product. A VPA can engage in two-way conversations with the user and, much like a real assistant, can carry out a number of tasks for them such as organizing mail, scheduling reminders

and many such activities that would otherwise need human intervention.

With "Actions on Google", a platform for app development, Google allows developers to develop their own services and apps that they can integrate with the Google Assistant and harness its two-way conversational interface for users.

Let us take a look at how an app on the Google Assistant looks like.

APPS ON GOOGLE ASSISTANT

A typical app for the Google Assistant can be broadly broken down into the following three parts:

Actions and Invocation

'Actions on Google' defines a way for the users to invoke apps for the Assistant through action-based voice commands such as "book an Uber" or "play a game". Every app must define at least a main action that lets users invoke it by name. In addition, it can then define additional actions that deep-link into the app through different entry points. An example of a deep-link invocation would be "Ok Google, Ask Stargazer to show me the star map for tomorrow" which, when spoken, should fire an intent to request the star map over the user location for the next day. These deep-link invocations are what make Actions really interesting.

*CODING MATTERS



* Hadoop 3 Adds HDFS Erasure Coding

improvements including support for HDFS Erasure coding, a preview of v2 of the YARN Timeline Service, and improvements to YARN/HDFS federation.
<http://dgit.in/Hadoop3HDFS>



* Python for Excel Scripting

Microsoft is considering providing Python as a scripting language in Excel and is currently asking for feedback from the developer community.
<http://dgit.in/PythnMSXL>



*GitHub Enterprise Adds Global Webhooks

Improvements include project board enhancements, global webhooks, and repository archiving. It also offers commit histories, code browsing etc.
<http://dgit.in/GitEntGWH>